

Shreenija Vadayar

CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST | EXPERIENTIAL DESIGN | VISUAL STORYTELLING

ABOUT ME

Creative technologist and multidisciplinary designer experienced in developing concepts into immersive experiences, visual systems, physical products, and audience-facing installations. Combines visual storytelling, experiential design, creative technology, fashion and textiles, fabrication, and project coordination to carry ideas from concept through production and presentation. First Prize winner of the Autodesk Make it Wearable Engineering Student Contest.

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CREATIVE SKILLS

Design & Experiential

Experiential Design | Spatial & Installation Design | Exhibition Design | Visitor Experience | Visual Storytelling | Creative Direction | Art Direction | Concept Development | Moodboards | Visual Presentations

Fashion, Textile & Object Design

Garment Construction | Sewing | Pattern Drafting & Modification | Textile & Material Exploration | Fashion Illustration | Upcycling | Styling | Physical Product Design

Creative Technology & Production

Interactive Design | Physical Computing | Arduino | Lighting Design & Production | Sound Production | Fabrication | 3D Printing | Laser Cutting

Creative Operations

Project & Production Coordination | Team Communication | Timeline & Schedule Management | Presentation Development | Rehearsal Coordination | Cross-Functional Collaboration

Creative Tools

Adobe Illustrator | Adobe Photoshop | Adobe InDesign | Figma | SolidWorks | SketchUp

SELECTED CREATIVE EXPERIENCES

WOVEN VOICES — Interactive Wearable Technology Installation | Senior Capstone | Lead Designer & Developer | Solo Project | September 2024 - May 2025

- Designed and built a solo interactive wearable installation featuring seven mechanical flowers that bloom and brighten as visitors approach and wilt and dim as they move away. First Prize — Autodesk Make it Wearable Engineering Student Contest.
- Developed the visual concept and narrative around human connection, adversity, healing, and support, drawing inspiration from designers including Iris van Herpen and Yin Gao.
- Designed the garment, color palette, textiles, materials, visual language, and mechanical flower aesthetics around lotus symbolism; developed the work through moodboards, sketches, renderings, and 3D models before fabricating the final piece.
- Engineered the interactive system using VL53L0X distance sensors, Adafruit Trinket M0 boards, NeoPixel LEDs, and micro servos, then programmed, tested, and refined the proximity-responsive behavior. Presented the completed installation at the 2025 CU Boulder Design Expo, engaging directly with 25+ visitors through the interactive experience.

BLACK BOX THEATER — Production & Experiential Design | University of Colorado Boulder | Production Team | October 2023 - May 2025

- Supported approximately 10–15 live productions across lighting, sound, backstage operations, ushering, doors, setup/breakdown, and performer/presenter coordination, adapting responsibilities to the needs of each production.
- Programmed and operated theatrical lighting cues for color changes, dimming effects, spotlights, timing, and scene transitions, preparing sequences in advance and manually triggering cues during live performances as needed.
- Prepared and adjusted physical lighting systems across the catwalk and lighting grid, including changing gobos, adjusting color and fixture positioning, and completing pre-show setup and technical checks.
- Supported sound production through track changes, volume control, and coordination between sound and lighting cues, while communicating across production teams to keep live performances running smoothly.
- Explored projection mapping, 360° projection, and motion capture as emerging tools for experiential and performance design.

FASHION, TEXTILE & UPCYCLING PROJECTS — Independent Creative Practice | Ongoing

- Design and construct original garments through pattern drafting, garment fitting, machine and hand sewing, finishing, closures, and iterative refinement, developing pieces from initial concept through finished construction.
- Modify and upcycle existing garments through deconstruction, reconstruction, pattern modification, and fit adjustments, including an ongoing kurthi-to-dress project and completed reconstructed garments.
- Explore color, texture, silhouette, draping, construction, and material behavior across fabrics including tulle, chiffon, cotton, muslin, linen, and polyester, developing practical solutions through hands-on experimentation.
- Develop a personal visual language that blends Indian and Western influences, combining Western silhouettes with Indian fabrics, patterns, detailing, and styling to explore cultural identity through fashion and visual storytelling.

ART DIRECTION & CREATIVE PRODUCTION — Independent Creative Practice | 2023 – Present

- Develop and direct fashion, editorial, dance, and cultural photography concepts from initial idea through production, using moodboards to establish styling, location, color, composition, mood, and visual storytelling across 10+ creative shoots.
- Lead creative production by sourcing and styling looks, coordinating photographers, models, and collaborators, managing schedules and locations, developing shot concepts, and directing on-set execution to translate visual concepts into cohesive imagery.
- Creative Director & Model for a culturally informed 1990s-inspired editorial published in BLAZE Magazine (October 2023), developing the concept, coordinating models and photographer, selecting the location, contributing to styling, and directing the visual narrative around cultural identity and cross-cultural expression.

CREATIVE PROJECT COORDINATION — Multidisciplinary Design & Performance Projects | University of Colorado Boulder | 2023 – 2025

- Coordinated multidisciplinary projects and live productions across teams of 3–20, establishing communication channels, master schedules, task assignments, check-ins, rehearsal plans, and shared project resources to keep work aligned and on schedule.
- Managed team workflows by delegating responsibilities around individual strengths and development goals, pairing teammates to share skills and supporting clear communication around dependencies, deadlines, and project needs.
- Reorganized a cross-disciplinary course team that was struggling with competing schedules and missed communication by creating a shared calendar, consolidating project deadlines, and establishing clear expectations; the team completed the semester with A grades and stronger collaboration.

DRISHTI TEA — Conceptual Brand & Packaging Design | University of Colorado Boulder

- Translated personal identity, personality, routines, preferences, and Indian-American cultural influences into a cohesive conceptual tea brand and packaging system.
- Developed the brand's visual direction through moodboards, typography, color, patterns, motifs, and intentional graphic relationships across the packaging.
- Designed packaging graphics and applied them to a 3D tin model, considering hierarchy, typography placement, composition, and how visual elements translated across different packaging faces.
- Created the final 3D packaging visualization using Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, and InDesign; developed the project as a portfolio-ready exploration of identity, visual storytelling, and packaging design.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SIMPLE SWITCH — Ethical Marketplace | Growth & Outreach Intern | May 2021 – August 2021

- Coordinated outreach and partnership development for an ethical marketplace connecting customers with small businesses creating positive social and environmental impact.
- Researched and curated potential product partners, collaborators, and creators for social media, marketing, PR, and product-trial initiatives, building a network of 25–35 prospective contacts.
- Conducted outreach that contributed to the onboarding of two new product vendors, while collaborating closely with a small startup team to support evolving partnership and marketing needs.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

B.S. Creative Technology & Design | May 2025
Minors: Business & Entrepreneurship; Leadership Studies

Women's Startup Program — Management & Entrepreneurship Certificate
IIM Bangalore (NSRCEL) & Goldman Sachs